

The next important step is installing the chipset drivers for your motherboard. This is important because XP might not recognise the motherboard chipset, in which case the full potential of the system will not be realised. All motherboard manufacturers post chipset drivers for their motherboards, and you can download the latest ones from their Web sites. You can also download them from the chipset manufacturers' Web sites.



The Windows Security Center

Once this is done, install the latest version of DirectX, which is a 3D API used by the latest games. DirectX is also necessary for smooth playback of video and audio using the DirectShow and Direct Sound components. (These are video and sound hardware accelerators respectively.) You can find the latest version of DirectX at www.microsoft.com/directx.

In a similar way, you might need to install device drivers for your display card, sound card, network card, TV-Tuner and so on, which, again, should be available at the respective manufacturers' Web sites. This completes the installation of XP.

Running Automatic Update will also provide you with the latest Microsoft-tested drivers for your hardware along with the latest security updates, bug fixes and service packs.

3.3 Creating User Accounts

Windows XP allows multiple users on a single computer, where each user can have his own settings. To create a user account, go to the Control Panel and click 'User Accounts'. In the window that opens, the names of all the current users are listed. New user